

# **ACME Corporation**

## **Human Resources Policy Manual**

Version 2.0 | Effective Date: January 1, 2024

Approved by: HR Director

# 1. Leave Policy

All full-time employees are entitled to 21 days of annual leave per calendar year. Part-time employees receive leave on a pro-rata basis calculated against a 40-hour work week.

Annual leave accrues at 1.75 days per month. Unused leave may be carried forward to the next calendar year, subject to a maximum carry-forward of 10 days.

Employees must submit leave requests at least 5 working days in advance through the HR portal. Emergency leave requests will be considered on a case-by-case basis by the line manager.

Annual leave cannot be encashed except upon termination of employment, where any accrued but unused leave will be paid out at the employee's basic daily rate.

## **2. Sick Leave Policy**

All employees are entitled to 14 days of paid sick leave per calendar year. Sick leave does not carry forward to the following year and cannot be encashed.

For absences of 1-2 days, employees must notify their line manager before 9:00 AM on the first day of absence. A self-declaration form must be submitted upon return.

For absences exceeding 2 consecutive days, a medical certificate from a registered medical practitioner must be submitted to HR within 3 working days of return.

Employees on extended sick leave exceeding 30 days may be required to undergo a medical examination arranged by the company. The company reserves the right to review employment status for absences exceeding 60 days.

### **3. Maternity and Paternity Leave**

Female employees who have completed at least 6 months of continuous service are entitled to 16 weeks of paid maternity leave. This may be taken from 4 weeks before the expected date of delivery.

Additional unpaid maternity leave of up to 4 weeks may be requested. This must be approved by the HR Director and line manager.

Male employees are entitled to 5 days of paid paternity leave, to be taken within 30 days of the child's birth. Paternity leave applies to both biological and adoptive fathers.

Adoption leave: Primary caregivers are entitled to 8 weeks of paid adoption leave upon formal adoption of a child under 12 years of age.

## **4. Work From Home Policy**

Employees may work from home up to 2 days per week, subject to manager approval and job function requirements. Customer-facing roles may have different arrangements.

Employees working from home are expected to be available during core hours: 9:00 AM to 5:00 PM. Attendance at mandatory meetings is required regardless of work location.

The company will provide a monthly home office allowance of \$50 to cover internet and utility costs for approved remote workers. This allowance is taxable.

Employees must ensure their home working environment meets basic health and safety standards. A self-assessment checklist must be submitted to HR before commencing remote work.

## **5. Performance Review Policy**

All employees undergo a formal performance review twice per year: mid-year in June and year-end in December. New employees are reviewed at the end of their probation period.

Performance is rated on a 5-point scale: 1-Unsatisfactory, 2-Needs Improvement, 3-Meets Expectations, 4-Exceeds Expectations, 5-Outstanding.

Employees rated 4 or 5 are eligible for a merit increment of 5-10% of their base salary. Employees rated 3 receive a standard increment of 3%. Employees rated 1 or 2 are placed on a Performance Improvement Plan.

All performance reviews must be documented in the HR system within 5 working days of the review meeting. Both employee and manager must sign the review form.

## 6. Code of Conduct

All employees are expected to maintain the highest standards of professional conduct. This includes treating colleagues, clients, and vendors with respect and dignity at all times.

Employees must declare any conflicts of interest to their line manager and HR in writing. Failure to disclose conflicts of interest may result in disciplinary action.

The use of company resources including computers, phones, and email for personal purposes is permitted within reasonable limits. Excessive personal use may be subject to disciplinary action.

Employees must not disclose confidential company information to external parties without written authorization from the relevant department head.

## **7. Grievance Policy**

Employees who have a grievance are encouraged to first resolve it informally by speaking directly with their line manager. If unresolved within 5 working days, a formal grievance may be submitted.

Formal grievances must be submitted in writing to HR using the Grievance Form available on the HR portal. HR will acknowledge receipt within 2 working days.

A formal grievance investigation will be completed within 15 working days. The employee will be informed of the outcome in writing. The employee may be accompanied by a colleague during any grievance meeting.

Appeals against grievance decisions must be submitted within 5 working days of receiving the outcome. The appeal will be heard by a senior manager not previously involved in the case.

## **8. Training and Development Policy**

The company is committed to the continuous development of its employees. Each employee is entitled to a minimum of 40 hours of training per year, which may include internal and external programs.

Employees may request external training or certification programs relevant to their role. Requests must be submitted to HR with a business justification. Approved training costs up to \$2,000 per year will be reimbursed.

Employees who receive company-sponsored certification costing more than \$500 are required to remain with the company for at least 12 months post-certification. Early departure may result in repayment of training costs.

A personal development plan must be agreed between the employee and line manager at the start of each year. Progress is reviewed during the mid-year performance review.

## 9. Termination Policy

Either party may terminate employment by giving the required notice period: 1 month for employees with less than 2 years of service, 2 months for 2-5 years, and 3 months for more than 5 years of service.

The company reserves the right to make payment in lieu of notice at the employee's basic salary rate. Garden leave may be applied during the notice period at the company's discretion.

Upon termination, employees must return all company property including laptops, access cards, and documents within 1 working day of the last day of employment.

Final salary payments including any accrued leave encashment will be processed within 5 working days of the last day of employment. Tax clearance must be obtained before final payment is released.

Employees terminated for gross misconduct will not be entitled to notice pay or leave encashment. Gross misconduct includes fraud, theft, harassment, and serious breach of company policy.